

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 538

By Hale

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Walter Glenn Birdwell, Jr., of Carthage.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that we learned of the passing of Walter Glenn Birdwell, Jr., a longtime banker who gave back to his Carthage community in numerous ways; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Birdwell was a graduate of Vanderbilt University, where he was a member of the Sigma Chi Fraternity and a member of the wrestling team during his varsity days; and

WHEREAS, most importantly, he met his future wife, Helen Walton, there, and it was at Vanderbilt they began their wonderful life together; and

WHEREAS, after graduation, Mr. Birdwell served his country in the United States Army during the Korean War; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Birdwell worked for seventy years at Citizens Bank of Carthage, which was founded by his father and local investors; the bank opened on October 26, 1929, three days before the stock market crash on Black Tuesday; and

WHEREAS, Walter Glenn Birdwell served with distinction as chairman of the board of Citizens Bank of Carthage from 1988 until his passing; a mere month before his death at the age of ninety-six, he still attended the bank's 7:30 a.m. meeting every day; and

WHEREAS, a giant in the industry, Mr. Birdwell was a board member of the Tennessee Bankers Association (TBA), was a founder and the first president of the TBA Young Bankers, and served as president of the TBA Independent Bankers Division; and

WHEREAS, he served the larger community as chairman of the Smith County Industrial Board, president of the Smith County Chamber of Commerce, and president of the Lions Club and as a member of the Smith County Help Center and Smith County Historical Society; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Birdwell expressed his faith at Carthage United Methodist Church, where he served in many leadership roles; and

WHEREAS, Walter Glenn Birdwell loved traveling the world with Helen, his beloved wife of seventy-two years; he was also an avid outdoorsman and loved duck hunting, snow skiing, and watersports; and

WHEREAS, he will be deeply mourned but fondly remembered by his loving family, including his wife; his children, Sue (Jerry) Ishee, Walter Glenn "Birdy" (Christie) Birdwell III, and Ann (Matt) Dobson; and his grandsons, Matthew H. Dobson VI and Walter Birdwell Dobson; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Birdwell was preceded in death by his parents, Catherine Hargis Birdwell and Walter Glenn Birdwell, Sr; and

WHEREAS, Walter Glenn Birdwell was an outstanding professional, a devoted family man, and a pillar of his community, and his passing creates a void that will not be easily filled; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Walter Glenn Birdwell, Jr., of Carthage, reflecting fondly upon his life of purpose and commitment to others.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Mr. Birdwell's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.